Akbar's fury, for he knew that Akbar was 'severe [on] breaches of military discipline'. Both men were, however, eventually forgiven.

After a short stay in Kabul, during which Akbar visited the quiet resting place of his grandfather at the Bagh-e-Babur, and having easily made his point, he pragmatically handed over the rule of the city to the mirza's sister, Bakht un-Nisa Begum, and returned to Fatehpur Sikri. Monserrate noted that while on the long journey to Kabul Akbar had had a white tent set up in the royal enclosure within which he had performed his prayers, on the way back 'he pretended not to notice that it was no longer erected'. With Mirza Hakim, the Timurid prince, neutralized, Akbar could now define a new identity for the Padshah of Hindustan. No longer would he feel the need to ostentatiously show himself to be a pious and orthodox Muslim monarch.

Indeed, Akbar seemed released of a burden that had cast a shadow over the past year of his life and he recovered his earlier lightness of spirit. When twelve deserters were captured and brought into custody, one of the men who had been assigned capital punishment begged for a chance to approach the Padshah. 'O King,' he pleaded, 'order me not to the gibbet, for nature has bestowed upon me marvellous powers in a certain direction.' Akbar's interest was piqued. '[I]n what direction do you thus excel, O miserable wretch?' the Padshah asked the harried prisoner. The man claimed he could sing wonderfully and when asked to demonstrate his skill, proceeded to croak in a 'discordant and harsh' manner so that everyone started murmuring and laughing. 'Pardon me this poor performance,' shouted out the prisoner, sensing that the Padshah was amused, 'for these guards of yours dragged me along so roughly and cruelly, on a hot and dusty road, and pummelled me so brutally with their fists, that my throat is full of dust, and my voice so husky that I cannot do myself justice in singing.' Akbar was so entertained by the man's ready wit that he pardoned not just him but also his fellow traitors.

There was less clemency for villages in the plains across the Khyber Pass, loyalists of Mirza Hakim who had refused to sell grain and supplies to the army despite being offered large sums of money. The villagers had fled their homes as soon as they heard that the great caravan was on its way back, and watched helplessly from across the river while their villages were put to the torch.

There were some among Akbar's party who demanded that Mirza Hakim be hunted down and executed. Akbar refused to do so, saying,